

performed heroic service, and in the two-year period, 39 medevac crew members were killed in action in Vietnam.

“You were just such a **target ...** [flying] the **medevac choppers.**”

MICHAEL BRADBURY, THIRD BATTALION OF THE 26TH MARINE REGIMENT, THIRD MARINE DIVISION, IN AN INTERVIEW, 2003



Rushed from the field

A wounded soldier of the 101st Airborne Division is carried to a waiting UH-1H after battle at Hamburger Hill. While medevac helicopters were required to be marked with a red cross, medics had stopped wearing this symbol.

Surviving the worst

Sixty-five percent of all wounds were to upper and lower extremities, leaving survivors with amputations or paralysis that would require long-term recuperation and rehabilitation. Of those who made it through the first 24 hours after injury, only one percent died. Overall, 19 percent of US casualties died from their wounds in Vietnam. One reason for these survival rates, which were better than in previous wars, was the less destructive nature of North Vietnamese and Viet Cong weapons. More than half of US deaths were from small arms, mines, and booby traps.

Treated abroad